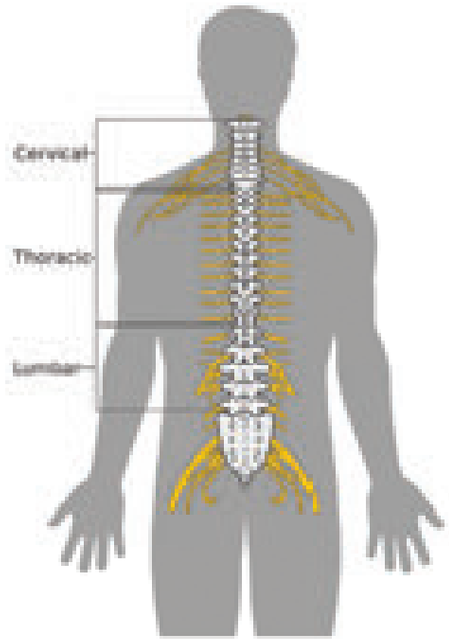
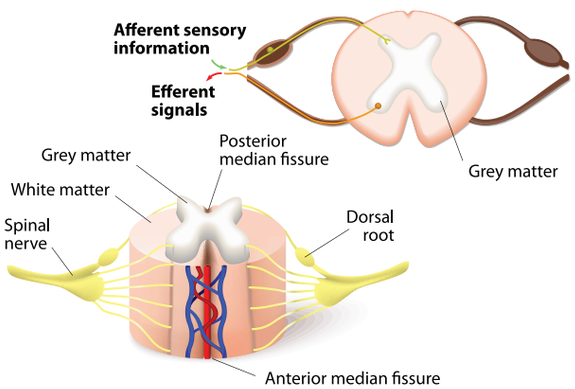
- Sacral region
- Coccyx, or tail bone, region



Spinal Cord



Spinal Cord C.S

The spinal cord has 31 nerve clusters which sends and receives motor and sensory messages to and from the rest of the body and it coordinates reflex action.

The Peripheral Nervous System

The Parts of the Peripheral Nervous System

Peripheral nervous system consists of all the parts of the nervous system other than the brain and the spinal cord. The peripheral nervous system is not protected with bones.

The peripheral nervous system is divided into two:

- Autonomic nervous system
- Somatic nervous system

Autonomic nervous system

The autonomic nervous system controls automatic and involuntary physiological functions of the body that are out of our control like the movements of smooth, involuntary muscles. For example, the constriction of the eye's pupil when it is exposed to bright light.

The autonomic nervous system's functions can be further divided into:

Sympathetic nervous system

Sympathetic nervous system is responsible for the fight and flight syndrome that results from stress. These responses include an increased heart rate, pupil dilation and decreased peristalsis.

Parasympathetic nervous system

The parasympathetic nervous system manages the functions related to rest. For example, the parasympathetic nervous system manages involuntary control of tears, digestion and the production of saliva.

Somatic nervous system

The somatic nervous system controls voluntary muscular movement with the skeletal muscles of the body. The somatic nervous system has efferent and afferent nerves which send and receive motor function related nerve signals.

Reflexes

A reflex is a muscle reaction that automatically occurs in response to a stimulus.

There are two types of reflexes.

Infant reflexes

Reflexes present at the time of birth, but disappear shortly thereafter.

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